

HINDUISM CANON

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Abstract

Example

hadleylab.org Governed Research. Every claim cited.

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Ultimate reality (Brahman) and individual self (Atman) are identical. Tat tvam asi Thou art That.

Example: The Mahavakyas (great sayings) of the Upanishads: - Prajnanam Brahma Consciousness is Brahman (Aitareya) - Aham Brahmasmi I am Brahman (Brihadaranyaka) - Tat Tvam Asi Thou art That (Chandogya) - Ayam Atma Brahma This Self is Brahman (Mandukya)

0.1 2. Shruti and Smriti

Revelation is twofold: heard (shruti = Vedas, Upanishads) and remembered (smriti = epics, Puranas, law codes).

Example: The Vedas are apaurusheya (not of human origin) they are the eternal sound (shabda) heard by rishis. The Mahabharata and Ramayana are smriti humanly composed but divinely inspired. Shruti outranks smriti.

0.2 3. Cyclical Time (Yugas)

Time is cyclical: four ages (Satya, Treta, Dvapara, Kali) repeat in maha-yugas, which compose kalpas (days of Brahma).

Example: We are in Kali Yuga the age of decline. But decline is temporary. After dissolution (pralaya), creation begins again. This IS temporal governance not linear progress but cosmic recursion.

0.3 4. Dharma-Varna-Ashrama

Social order is governed by dharma (cosmic order), manifested through varna (social function) and ashrama (life stage).

Example: Four varnas (Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra) and four ashramas (student,

householder, forest dweller, renunciant). Svadharma (ones own duty) depends on both varna and ashrama. The Bhagavad Gitas central teaching: Better ones own dharma poorly done than anothers done well (3:35).

0.4 5. Karma and Samsara

Actions (karma) produce consequences across lifetimes (samsara). Liberation (moksha) is release from the cycle.

Example: As a person acts, so they become (Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 4.4.5). Karma IS operational governance every action has consequences, the universe is self-enforcing.

0.5 6. Multiple Paths (Margas)

Hinduism recognizes multiple valid paths to liberation: knowledge (jnana), devotion (bhakti), action (karma), meditation (raja).

Example: The Bhagavad Gita presents all four margas. Krishna teaches Arjuna: Whatever path people travel is My path (4:11). This structural pluralism is unique multiple valid architectures for the same goal.

1. Constraints

MUST: Cite textual source (shruti or smriti) for doctrinal claims

MUST: Distinguish between sampradayas (Shaiva, Vaishnava, Shakta)

MUST NOT: Reduce Hindu diversity to a single philosophical school

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